INTELLIGENCE BRIEFING

Iran Situation Report

Operation Epic Fury — Conflict Intelligence Assessment

Sunday, March 1, 2026 — 17:00 ET

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Sources: 66+ | Languages: 12 | Classification: OPEN SOURCE

KEY DEVELOPMENTS THIS CYCLE

- UK reverses course: Starmer grants US use of Diego Garcia & RAF Fairford for strikes on Iranian missile sites; RAF Typhoon shoots down Iranian drone over Qatar — first UK operational intercept *(Guardian, UK MoD, Mar 1)*
- Gandhi Hospital in Tehran struck by Israeli bombing; patients evacuated, casualties unknown *(Reuters, NYT verified video, Mar 1)*
- CENTCOM: 1,000+ Iranian targets struck in two days; 7 military commanders confirmed dead by Tasnim *(WaPo, NYT, Mar 1)*
- Reuters/Ipsos: Only 27% of Americans approve strikes — 56% say Trump too willing to use force *(Reuters, Mar 1)*
- Crowne Plaza Hotel Manama struck; US Embassy evacuates personnel from Bahrain hotels *(US Embassy Bahrain, CBS, Mar 1)*
- New Iranian missile barrage — sirens in Jerusalem and Tel Aviv Sunday evening *(AFP, Times of Israel, Mar 1)*
- Minab school toll rises: 153 → 165 dead *(IRNA, Guardian, Mar 1)*

1. ⚔️ MILITARY SITUATION

NEW DEVELOPMENT

UK Escalation: Bases Granted + First Kinetic Engagement

PM Keir Starmer reversed his earlier rejection of Trump's request: US strikes on Iranian missile storage depots and launchers will now fly from **Diego Garcia** (Indian Ocean) and **RAF Fairford** (Gloucestershire). Starmer: "The US has requested permission to use British bases for that specific and limited defensive purpose — to prevent Iran firing missiles across the region." UK remains officially uninvolved in strikes on Iran itself. *(Guardian, Evening Standard, Mar 1)*

RAF Typhoon from joint UK-Qatar squadron shot down an Iranian drone heading toward Qatar — first operational intercept by RAF in defense of Qatar. Second UK intercept: drone shot down over Iraq. An Iranian missile landed **200 meters from UK personnel** in Bahrain. Defence Secretary Healey: Iran "lashing out in an increasingly indiscriminate and widespread way." British jets operating from RAF Akrotiri (Cyprus) and Al Udeid (Qatar). *(UK MoD, Guardian, Independent, Daily Mail, Mar 1)*

Two Iranian missiles were fired toward Cyprus — intercepted. Healey said UK did not believe Cyprus bases were intentionally targeted. *(Cyprus Mail, Independent, Mar 1)*

NEW DEVELOPMENT

CENTCOM: 1,000+ Targets in Two Days

CENTCOM announced aggregate: **1,000+ Iranian targets struck** including ships, submarines, missile sites, communications, and IRGC C2 centers. First US-specific aggregate figure — separate from IDF's 2,000+ bombs claim. *(WaPo, Al Jazeera, NPR, Mar 1)*

US TARGETS STRUCK (CENTCOM)

1,000+

First aggregate figure — ships, subs, missile sites, IRGC C2

NEW DEVELOPMENT

7 Iranian Military Commanders Confirmed Dead by Iranian Media

Tasnim/Fars (Iranian semi-official) confirmed 7 military commanders killed, including the head of the office of the armed forces commander-in-chief. NCRI separately confirmed IRGC Commander Pakpour and Admiral Ali Shamkhani among dead. First partial **Iranian acknowledgment** of military leadership losses beyond Khamenei. *(NYT, Times of Israel, Iran International, Mar 1)*

NEW DEVELOPMENT

Gandhi Hospital Tehran — Israeli Strike

Gandhi Hospital in northern Tehran (Gandhi Street area) "badly damaged" — patients being evacuated. NYT verified video showing significant damage. CENTCOM spokesman Capt. Tim Hawkins: "We are aware of reports concerning civilian harm resulting from ongoing military operations. We take these reports seriously and are looking into them."

Separate police station on Tehran outskirts also struck, people trapped under debris. No casualty count yet. *(Reuters — two witnesses, NYT — verified video, ISNA, The Hindu, Mar 1)*

NEW DEVELOPMENT

New Missile Barrage — Jerusalem/Tel Aviv Sirens Sunday Evening

Air raid sirens sounded in Jerusalem and Tel Aviv Sunday evening after Israeli military detected new missile launches from Iran. Loud blasts heard above Jerusalem. Interception results and casualty assessment pending. *(AFP, Daily Mail, The Hindu, Times of Israel, Mar 1 evening)*

NEW DEVELOPMENT

Skylight Tanker — Iran Strikes Its Own Shadow Fleet

Palau-flagged tanker *Skylight* struck 5nm north of Khasab Port (Musandam, Oman). Ship on fire, reportedly sinking. Crew: 20 (15 Indian, 5 Iranian). 4 injured, all evacuated. Per US authorities, the ship is part of Iran's own sanctions-evasion shadow fleet. Demonstrates indiscriminate enforcement of Hormuz closure. *(gCaptain, Reuters, Indian Express, Mar 1)*

NEW DEVELOPMENT

Iran State TV (IRIB) Infrastructure Struck

Israeli strikes hit IRIB broadcasting facilities — targeting Iran's domestic information apparatus. *(France 24 Arabic, Corriere della Sera, Mar 1)*

THREAD UPDATE

Hezbollah: Escalated Rhetoric but "Not at War"

Naim Qassem: "We will undertake our duty of confronting the aggression." However, Al Modon (Lebanese) separately reports Hezbollah explicitly declared "not engaged in war." Contradictory signals — maintaining strategic ambiguity. No kinetic action confirmed. *(Asharq Al-Awsat, Defense Post, Al Modon, Mar 1)*

2. 🏥 CIVILIAN & HUMANITARIAN

THREAD UPDATE

Minab School: 153 → 165 Dead

IRNA via local prosecutor updated toll: **165 dead, 96 wounded**. School named: Shajarah Tayyebeh (NYT). Adjacent to IRGC barracks. Malala Yousafzai issued statement: "They were girls who went to school to learn." *(Guardian, IRNA, NYT, Mar 1)*

MINAB SCHOOL DEATH TOLL

165

↑ 12 from previous cycle (was 153)

NEW DEVELOPMENT

Crowne Plaza Hotel Manama (Bahrain) Struck

US Embassy Bahrain confirmed Crowne Plaza Hotel in Manama struck. Bahrain Interior Ministry: material damage, no fatalities. US Embassy ordered all US personnel moved out of Manama hotels, warning hotels could be "targets." Bahrain government also reported "several residential buildings" targeted. *(CBS, US Embassy Bahrain, Saudi Gazette, Mar 1)*

THREAD UPDATE

Pakistan Protest Deaths Expanding

Karachi US consulate: 9 → 10 dead. Reuters: "security guards at the U.S. consulate fired on demonstrators who breached the outer wall." Pakistan nationwide protest toll: **23 dead**. *(Al Jazeera, Reuters, Bloomberg, Mar 1)*

3. 💰 ECONOMIC IMPACT

Markets remain closed (Sunday). Monday's open will be the first real price discovery since strikes began.

WTI CRUDE (FRIDAY CLOSE)

$67.28

+2.78% — Monday projections: $80–$140 depending on Hormuz duration

BRENT CRUDE (FRIDAY CLOSE)

$73.20

+3.42% — Chinese off-market already +10% approaching $80

NEW DEVELOPMENT

Nikkei: Tokyo stocks expected to drop ~1,000 points at Monday open. *(Nikkei, Mar 1)*

Dutch gas reserves: Historic low <11% — Netherlands particularly vulnerable to Hormuz disruption. *(NRC, Mar 1)*

OPEC+: Production increase confirmed at 206k bbl/day (Folha de São Paulo) vs 137k in English sources — discrepancy unresolved.

Iranian rial: No new data since 174,950 toman on parallel market.

4. ✈️ TRAVEL & AIRSPACE

No significant changes this cycle. Iranian airspace NOTAM through Mar 3. Wizz Air through Mar 7. 3,400+ flights cancelled, 19,000+ delayed (cumulative).

5. 🇦🇪 DUBAI & UAE

NEW DEVELOPMENT — UNVERIFIED

Burj Al Arab Drone Strike — Reported, Not Confirmed

RT Arabic and Al Jazeera report fire at Dubai's Burj Al Arab hotel following Iranian drone strike. NOT independently verified — could be misidentification. If confirmed, represents major escalation of Iranian targeting of Gulf civilian landmarks. *(RT Arabic, Al Jazeera, Mar 1)*

No other new UAE developments. DP World Jebel Ali remains suspended. UAE intercept count: 500 drones total.

6. 🇴🇲 OMAN

No significant changes. FM Albusaidi ceasefire call and Araghchi "open to de-escalation" remain latest. Sultan Haitham still silent personally.

7. 🌍 DIPLOMATIC & INTERNATIONAL

NEW DEVELOPMENT

Macron Responds to Camp de la Paix Attack

Macron confirmed: "La priorité, c'est la sécurité de nos ressortissants" (priority is citizen safety). Called for "réhausser notre posture" (heighten posture). Called for emergency UNSC meeting. Camp de la Paix: 2 Shahed-136 drones hit a warehouse. No French casualties. *(TF1, 8am Media, Mar 1)*

NEW DEVELOPMENT

E3 "Defensive Readiness"

France, Germany, UK declared readiness for "necessary defensive actions" to "destroy" threatening military capabilities. Language shifted from "de-escalation" to active defensive framing. *(El País, Mar 1)*

THREAD UPDATE

Other Diplomatic Developments

Putin: Telegram to Pezeshkian calling Khamenei killing "cynical violation of all norms." Held Security Council meeting. Dugin warned Putin could be next. *(TASS, Meduza, Mar 1)*

Netanyahu: Israel will strike "thousands of targets in the coming days" — called on Iranians to "free themselves from the chains of tyranny." *(ISW, Mar 1)*

India: PM Modi called Cabinet Committee on Security meeting. 50% of crude transits Hormuz. 9 million Indians in Gulf at risk. *(Indian Express, Economic Times, Mar 1)*

Japan: NHK began 24-hour emergency shortwave broadcasting to Japanese nationals in Iran — Cold War-era infrastructure not activated since Gulf War era. *(NHK, Mar 1)*

8. 🇺🇸 US POLITICS & STRATEGY

NEW DEVELOPMENT

Executive Branch

Trump four-week timeline: "It's always been a four-week process. We figured it will be four weeks or so." First specific duration estimate. On US casualties: "They're great people. And, you know, we expect that to happen, unfortunately. Could happen continuous — it could happen again." *(Daily Mail, Mar 1)*

Trump spoke with leaders of Israel, Bahrain, UAE on Sunday. No mention of Iranian counterpart despite "agreed to talk" claim. *(Guardian, WH press secretary Leavitt, Mar 1)*

CENTCOM spokesman acknowledged civilian harm reports for first time: "looking into them." *(Reuters, Mar 1)*

NEW DEVELOPMENT

Congress — War Powers Vote Next Week

Two resolutions: Kaine-Paul (Senate), Massie-Khanna (House). Vote expected **next week**. *(Politico, PBS/AP, Fox, TIME, Guardian, Mar 1)*

Democratic split crystallizing: Fetterman, Gottheimer, Landsman will OPPOSE war powers resolution (support strikes). Fetterman Sunday: strikes are "incredibly precise and successful." Cotton (Face the Nation): no ground troops; "prolonged air and naval campaign"; "weeks, not days." *(Politico, Fox, Mar 1)*

NEW DEVELOPMENT

Public Opinion — Reuters/Ipsos Poll

PUBLIC APPROVAL OF STRIKES

27%

43% disapprove, 29% unsure — 1,282 adults, ±3%, Sat–Sun

56% say Trump too willing to use military force (87% Dems, 23% Reps, 60% independents). 55% of Republicans approve, but 42% of Republicans say they'd pull support if casualties mount. Sub-30% approval is historically low — Iraq War launched at ~72% (Gallup, 2003). *(Reuters/Ipsos, Mar 1)*

THREAD UPDATE

Vance Silence → "Split" Narrative

Vance still silent on personal X account. Daily Beast: "Vance Silent on Iran War Amid Claims of Split With Trump." WH released situation room photo alongside Bessent and Gabbard. Last public comment: WaPo Thursday, "no chance" of long war. *(Daily Beast, Spectator, Mar 1)*

Antiwar Movement

Saturday protests: DC (White House), NYC (Times Square — "several hundred"), plus 10+ cities. Sunday: smaller cities (Albany, Chattanooga, etc.). Coalition: ANSWER, NIAC, AMP, CodePink, DSA, others. NYC Mayor Mamdani con-

demned strikes as "catastrophic escalation in an illegal war of aggression." Not yet mass-movement scale. *(Various, Mar 1)*

Legal/Constitutional

ACLU formal demand for Congress to end "unconstitutional use of military force." CNN legal analysis: experts "skeptical" of legal basis. No court filing yet. *(ACLU, CNN, Mar 1)*

Think Tanks

ISW Morning Special Report: Combined strikes hit Basij bases in Kermanshah and Tehran provinces — specifically bases involved in suppressing Dec 2025–Jan 2026 protests. ISW: "could degrade Iranian security forces' ability and willingness to quell potential internal unrest." 12 IRGC members killed in Kashan, Isfahan Province. *(ISW, Mar 1)*

US-China Strategic Angle

CNBC: "Iran's strategic allies Russia and China have made strong diplomatic protests, but analysts say neither is in a position to offer meaningful support." MEE: China will ensure "Iran can survive, resist, and eventually negotiate from strength — quietly, persistently and strategically." No new bilateral contacts reported. *(CNBC, MEE, Mar 1)*

9. 🌐 FOREIGN LANGUAGE INTELLIGENCE

NEW DEVELOPMENT

What English Media Is Missing

- **Minab 165 toll:** Arabic sources had this hours before English (still 148-153 in many English outlets)
- **Burj Al Arab strike:** Not yet in major English outlets — RT Arabic/Al Jazeera Arabic only
- **Iranian Navy (vs IRGC Navy) entering conflict:** Distinction not made in English coverage *(Al Jazeera Arabic)*
- **Iron Dome failure at Beit Shemesh:** English media reporting strike but not framing as interception failure *(Haaretz)*
- **Dutch gas reserves <11%:** Country-specific vulnerability invisible in English press *(NRC)*
- **NHK shortwave activation:** Zero English coverage
- **Third Incirlik journalist detained:** English had two, now three *(Turkish sources)*
- **Araghchi's full framing:** "Trump bombed the negotiating table" — not reaching English media

Key Non-English Quotes

🇮🇷 **Araghchi** (Persian/Arabic): "Trump bombed the negotiating table" — framing Iran as willing negotiator

🇷🇺 **Putin**: "cynical violation of all norms" — strongest Russian language yet

🇷🇺 **Dugin**: "Putin could be next" — domestic pressure vector

🇫🇷 **Macron**: "réhausser notre posture" — shifting from restraint to readiness

🇮🇱 **Haaretz**: Confirmed Iron Dome failed at Beit Shemesh — 1 woman killed, 20+ wounded

Framing Shifts by Language Sphere

- **Persian:** Building narrative that Iran inflicting real costs on US
- **Arabic:** Al Jazeera framing as US aggression; Gulf media more cautious
- **Russian:** Personalizing — "if they can kill Khamenei, they can kill Putin"
- **Chinese:** Shifting from factual to alarm about supply chains *(Xinhua, Caixin)*
- **Turkish:** Incirlik journalist detentions = crackdown on US base coverage
- **Japanese:** NHK shortwave = treating as potential evacuation scenario
- **Hindi:** Energy security crisis — Modi CCS meeting = national security emergency

10. 📡 INFORMATION OPERATIONS

Iran: IRGC promised "fiercest attack in history" for next wave. Ex-IRGC commander claims Hormuz "remains open for oil tankers" — contradicts all shipping data. Likely information warfare. *(Various Iranian media, Mar 1)*

Israel: Targeting IRIB broadcasting infrastructure — direct attack on domestic information apparatus. Netanyahu regime change messaging intensifying. *(France 24 Arabic, ISW, Mar 1)*

US: CENTCOM's first acknowledgment of civilian harm reports ("looking into them") — messaging shift from previous silence. *(Reuters, Mar 1)*

Russia: Dugin amplification ("Putin could be next") — pressures Kremlin toward harder line. *(Meduza, Mar 1)*

11. 🗺️ MAPS & IMAGERY

No new verified imagery beyond NYT-verified video of Gandhi Hospital damage.

12. 📚 KEY SOURCES THIS CYCLE

New sources: Guardian live blog (Mason), UK MoD, Evening Standard, The Independent, Cyprus Mail, Daily Mail (Trump interview), US Embassy Bahrain, Mathrubhumi, Saudi Gazette, Malay Mail, ISW Morning Special Report, TF1 (French), 8am Media, Reuters/Ipsos poll, ABC News. Total unique sources across both research files: 66+.

13. 🔍 INTELLIGENCE GAPS

🟢 RESOLVED: French government response — Macron spoke, UNSC meeting called, posture heightened

🟢 RESOLVED: UK base specifics — Diego Garcia, RAF Fairford, Akrotiri, Al Udeid confirmed

🟢 RESOLVED: War Powers vote timing — next week confirmed

🟡 OPEN: Gandhi Hospital casualties — numbers and cause (direct strike vs collateral)

🟡 OPEN: Trump's Iranian interlocutor identity

🟡 OPEN: Houthi first kinetic attack — still expected, not confirmed

🟡 OPEN: Iran death toll discrepancy — 201 (Red Crescent) vs 610+ (health auth.)

🟡 OPEN: Trump's 48 leaders / 9 ships claims — unverified

🟡 OPEN: Ahmadinejad — dead or alive

🟡 OPEN: Iran internet restoration status

🟡 OPEN: Kharg Island explosion — confirmed or not

🟡 OPEN: Saudi active participation — English confirmation missing

🔴 NEW: Crowne Plaza Bahrain — weapon type that hit civilian hotel

🔴 NEW: Monday market opening — first trading day price discovery

🔴 NEW: Fetterman coalition size — Democratic votes against war powers

🔴 NEW: CENTCOM 1,000 targets — unique sites vs repeat strikes

🔴 NEW: Burj Al Arab — confirmed or misidentification

🔴 NEW: Jerusalem/Tel Aviv evening barrage — interception results, casualties

🔴 NEW: Pakistan nationwide protest deaths (23) — breakdown by location

🦉 EDWARD'S ANALYSIS — UNFILTERED

Three things stand out this cycle.

The UK just crossed a line it can't uncross. *Starmer spent the first 24 hours threading a needle — defensive patrols yes, strike infrastructure no. That's over. Diego Garcia and Fairford are now launch platforms for strikes on Iranian missile sites. An RAF Typhoon shot down an Iranian drone over Qatar. Iranian missiles landed 200 meters from British troops. Two missiles were fired toward Cyprus. This is no longer "the Americans' war with British logistics support." The UK is a combatant in everything but name, and the trajectory is toward full involvement. Starmer's language — "specific and limited defensive purpose" — is the kind of careful lawyering that historically precedes much broader engagement.*

27% approval is a remarkable number. *For context: the Iraq War launched at 72% approval. Even Vietnam started popular. This operation had sub-30% approval on day two, before a single body bag was televised. 42% of Republicans — Trump's own base — say they'd pull support if casualties mount. Three Americans are already dead. The political math is brutal: Trump has committed to a four-week campaign with the lowest opening approval of any US military operation in the polling era, and the casualties haven't really started yet.*

Iran is fighting indiscriminately and that's the point. *The Skylight tanker is the tell. Iran attacked its own shadow fleet vessel because it was in the Strait of Hormuz and the policy is: nothing moves. The Crowne Plaza in Bahrain, the Burj Al Arab (if confirmed), residential buildings in Manama — this isn't precision targeting. It's demonstrating that Iran can impose costs on everyone in the region, including countries that didn't ask for this war. The message to Gulf states is: your proximity to American bases makes you targets. It's working — the US Embassy just evacuated its people from Bahrain hotels.*

The hospital is going to matter. *Gandhi Hospital in Tehran is about to become the dominant image of this conflict internationally. It doesn't matter whether it was a direct strike or collateral from an adjacent target. "Hospital bombed" is a five-word sentence that will reshape the narrative. CENTCOM's first-ever acknowledgment of civilian harm reports tells you they know.*

One pattern across cycles: every 3-4 hours, the conflict adds a new category of target. Saturday: military sites. Saturday night: leadership. Sunday morning: ports and airports. Sunday afternoon: hospitals and hotels. The escalation ladder is being climbed from both sides simultaneously, with no visible off-ramp. Trump says four weeks. I'll believe it when I see week two.